Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	North	
	♠ A K 6 ♥ A ♦ A K J 5 3 2 ♣ Q J 2	
♠ 8 5 3 ♥ 8 6 5 2 ♦ Q 9 7 ♣ A T 5	N W E S	♠ Q J T 9 7 2 ♥ 9 7 4 ♦ 8 ♣ K 9 3
	♠ 4 ♥ K Q J T 3 ♦ T 6 4 ♣ 8 7 6 4	

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♦	Pass	3♥
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠Q.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=0 Total = 5

There they are, four perfectly good ♥ tricks and no straightforward way to reach them. On the other hand, (I should say "In the other hand"), you have the possibility of 6 ♦ tricks, if the ♦Q drops, in which case you won't need the ♥ tricks at all. Can you work those two possibilities into a strategy?

Sure. The ♦ problem is that the outstanding ♦s may split 3-1 with one defender holding ♦ Q x x. So it would appear you could only get 5 ♦ winners. But you can thwart him like this.

Win the ♠. Unblock the ♥A. Now play the ♦J. If Mr. ♦ Q x x takes this trick dummy's ♦10 will become an entry to those wonderful ♥s. But if he cleverly refuses to win the ♦Q, then it will fall under your ♦ A K and you will get all 6 ♦ tricks.

The biggest problem with this great play is that West probably doesn't know for sure what you are doing to him.

Maybe after the hand is over he will appreciate it more and congratulate you.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 6 2 ♥ Q J 9 4 ♦ T 3 ♣ 9 7 6 2	
♠ K ♥ A K 7 5 3 ♦ A K Q 6 ♣ K T 5	N W E S	♠ Q J T 9 3 ♥ 6 2 ♦ 8 5 4 ♣ A J 3
	♠ 8 7 5 4 ♥ T 8 ♦ J 9 7 2 ♣ Q 8 4	

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♥	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♦2.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 8

The reason the Winners list shows 1 ♠ is that the defenders are going to have to let you win dummy's ♠K. If they take that then you'll have 4 ♠ winners in your hand!

So you only need one more winner really, and if you guess the ♣ finesse right you will have it. Which way will you finesse, and why?

You will finesse through North. If he has the ♣Q you will win all 3 ♣ tricks, but if South has the ♣Q you may win even more. Just watch.

Win the opening ♦ lead in dummy. Play the ♠K which the defenders are not about to take while you have a ♣ entry to your hand. Now play the ♣T and pass it to South. If South takes the ♣Q then you will have TWO entries to your hand, one to get there for a ♠ lead, and the other to reach the ♠ winners after you have driven out the ♠A. But if South DOESN'T take the ♣Q, or if North actually has it, then you will have 3 ♣ tricks and your contract.

Isn't it nice to have a finesse that wins if it wins but also wins if it loses?

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	North	
	♠ Q 6 ♥ A Q J 8 4 ♦ 7 5 3 ♣ 6 4 2	
West ♠ T 9 8 5 2 ♥ 9 7 5 2 ♦ J 4 ♣ K 5	N W E S	**East** ♠ J 7 4 3 ♥ 6 ♦ Q T 9 2 ♣ Q 8 7 3
	♠ A K ♥ K T 3 ♦ A K 8 6 ♣ A J T 9	

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♠T.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=5 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 10

You need two more winners and the best bet is to try to pick up three ♣ tricks. You will need the ♣K and ♣Q to lie in different hands, or both of them to be with East. That is about a 75% chance.

But you may need to make 3 finesses, so that means 3 entries to dummy, all of which must be in the ♥ suit. Can it be done?

Of course it can. Win the ♠ lead in your hand and play the ♥K, overtaking with dummy's ♥A. Now play a ♣ to your ♣9, which loses to West's ♣K. West plays another ♠.

Now play the ♥10, and when West follows you are safe to overtake with dummy's ♥J since you can tell that East did not start with 4 ♥s. In fact, East shows out so it is West who started with 4 ♥s but that won't be a problem for you. Play another ♣ from dummy, finessing the ♣T which wins.

Now play your ♥3 toward dummy, finessing the ♥8 when West follows with a low card. Play dummy's two ♥ winners, discarding ♦s, then the low ♣ to your ♣J. Wow.

The making of a Plan is a very important step in being a good Declarer.

And as you have figured by now, assessing how many entries you are going to need is big part of that plan. Like here, if you had won a single ♥ trick in your hand then you wouldn't have had the three entries to dummy.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

North:
♠ T 4
♥ J 9 2
♦ Q J T 3
♣ T 8 6 2

West:
♠ A K Q J 9 7
♥ -
♦ A K 6 2
♣ A J 5

N
W E
S

East:
♠ 8
♥ A K 8 6 5 4 3
♦ 8 5 4
♣ Q 3

South:
♠ 6 5 3 2
♥ Q T 7
♦ 9 7
♣ K 9 7 4

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♥	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			

6♠ by West

Pretty bold bidding by West, but partner DID make a positive response. West is to play 6♠. North leads the ♦Q.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 3

OK, the plan is to get over to dummy for those two ♥ winners.

If you just play a small ♣ toward the ♣Q that will work whenever North holds the ♣K.

How about playing ♣A an a small ♣, planning on ruffing your third ♣ to get to dummy? Naaah. They will win the second ♣ and play a trump.

There is actually a play that is 100% certain, no matter who holds the ♣K.

Win the opening lead and lay down your ♣J. The defense is helpless. If they take the ♣J with the ♣K, then you have a dummy entry in the form of the ♣Q. If they refuse to take the trick you will counter by next laying down the ♣A, then ruffing a third ♣ to get to dummy and the two golden eggs.

The first time I ever saw this type of play in a book I fell in love with it.

My dream is that someday I will get a chance to use it at the table. If you ever do be sure and email me.